



Instagram Ads

Instagram's advertising base has doubled, exceeding 500,000.
<http://dgit.in/InstagramAds>



Android on Chrome OS

Google plans to bring support for Android apps to Chrome OS.
<http://dgit.in/AndChrmOS>

The Toys

While apps and video based platforms do make the learning process enjoyable and interesting, continuous exposure to a digital display might end up being quite harmful to a child's vision. Also, not all parents are sure about handing over their own devices to their kids. After all, would you be comfortable giving your latest smartphone to a 2-year old? Keeping all these concerns in mind, manufacturers and startups are coming up with interesting products that are meant to engage the kid physically as well as provide digital content.

Flintobox is a subscription based Indian startup that ships engagement kits to your doorstep. This is especially useful for parents who are too busy with work-life to sit and figure out the activities that will benefit their children. A typical Flintobox is theme based and contains multiple indoor activity kits like Mini Golf, along with educational content based on the theme that helps children learn more about the topic while having fun. Magic Crate and Kompanion's Kube are two other startups with similar offerings. Both Flintobox and Kube have accompanying smartphone apps that are also an integral part of their offering.

There are tablet manufacturers who are making devices specifically with kids in mind. Intel's Eddy tablet is one such device that is available online and comes with a protective case that can take occasional bumps. It comes with more than 160 applications and 100 books selected by educators. A more India oriented device would be the Lenovo CG Slate. While the tablet itself is manufactured by Lenovo and runs on Android Kitkat, the tablet is accompanied by a 32GB SD card.

STEM CELL PRESERVATION

Stem cells are widely used in regenerative medicine to treat a number of serious medical issues like damaged tissues, organ transplants and even cancer treatment. And one of the primary source of stem cells is the umbilical cord blood, which can be preserved in modern day cord blood banks. One of the first companies to offer this service in India is Lifecell, although there are more options out there now like Cordlife, Babycell and more.

The CG Slate also sends progress reports to parents via SMS and email, and also allows parents to monitor the progress directly on the software in Parent Mode. On top of that, you can have multiple profiles on the same tablet, thus eliminating the need to buy different devices for your children. And since it is a fully functional android tablet, even you can use it.

For a section marked "The Toys", it would be silly if we didn't talk about actual toys for kids, wouldn't it? Thankfully, some creative startups have covered that special aspect of childhood as well! Toys-On-Rent is an online toy library that lets parents rent toys for their children based on a number of plans available. Any parent would agree that kids aren't exactly good at keeping their toys intact, or playing with them for a long time. So the availability of toy rental libraries is solving both of those problems at once. With the guarantee of the toys being sanitized and properly checked before delivery, renting plans from libraries like toys-on-rent is a great option for parents.

around the world who make things for children and parents alike are adapting technology into their products.

Women's health company Bloomlife says that its goal is to improve the health of mothers and babies by combining connected devices with data analytics to provide insights that reassure an expecting mother and keep her informed about the progress of her pregnancy. Their first device is Belli, a smart wearable to be used during the third trimester that tracks contractions and other details. This data is represented usefully in a mobile app where it helps the mother to plan their big day. And a future update to the device and the application plans to bring in additional insights like stress, sleep, kick counts, and activity levels while also incorporating a simple QnA feature that helps moms put their doubts to rest. This device not only saves an expecting mother quite a few possibly hectic trips to the doctor, the analytics provided by it are helpful to the doctor being consulted as well!

Another category of devices that comes strongly recommended from parents is a video baby monitor setup. This would essentially require a connected camera setup in the baby's room or around the house and an application to monitor it remotely. The Motorola MBP26 Video Baby Monitor is a good option available in India. It comes with a 2.4" LCD monitor and has a parent-baby camera setup (they've definitely named it right) that even supports infrared monitoring for night.

Good Parenting

While one of technology's greatest gifts is that it does our work for us, it also brings about a lack of attention and increased distractions in most things we do, which could be especially harmful when parenting. All the apps, tablets, and gadgets in the world can't substitute a parent's instinct. So, for expecting and new parents alike, it is essential to remember that all of this technology is to make the huge responsibility of bringing up a child a bit easier to bear, not make it a lesser responsibility altogether!



Future models of Belli will have additional features like kick count!

The Tools

When it comes to technology and parenting influencing each other, there is more to it than just apps, kids tablets and content platforms. Manufacturers